



A Whisper Over Water

picture by Echo

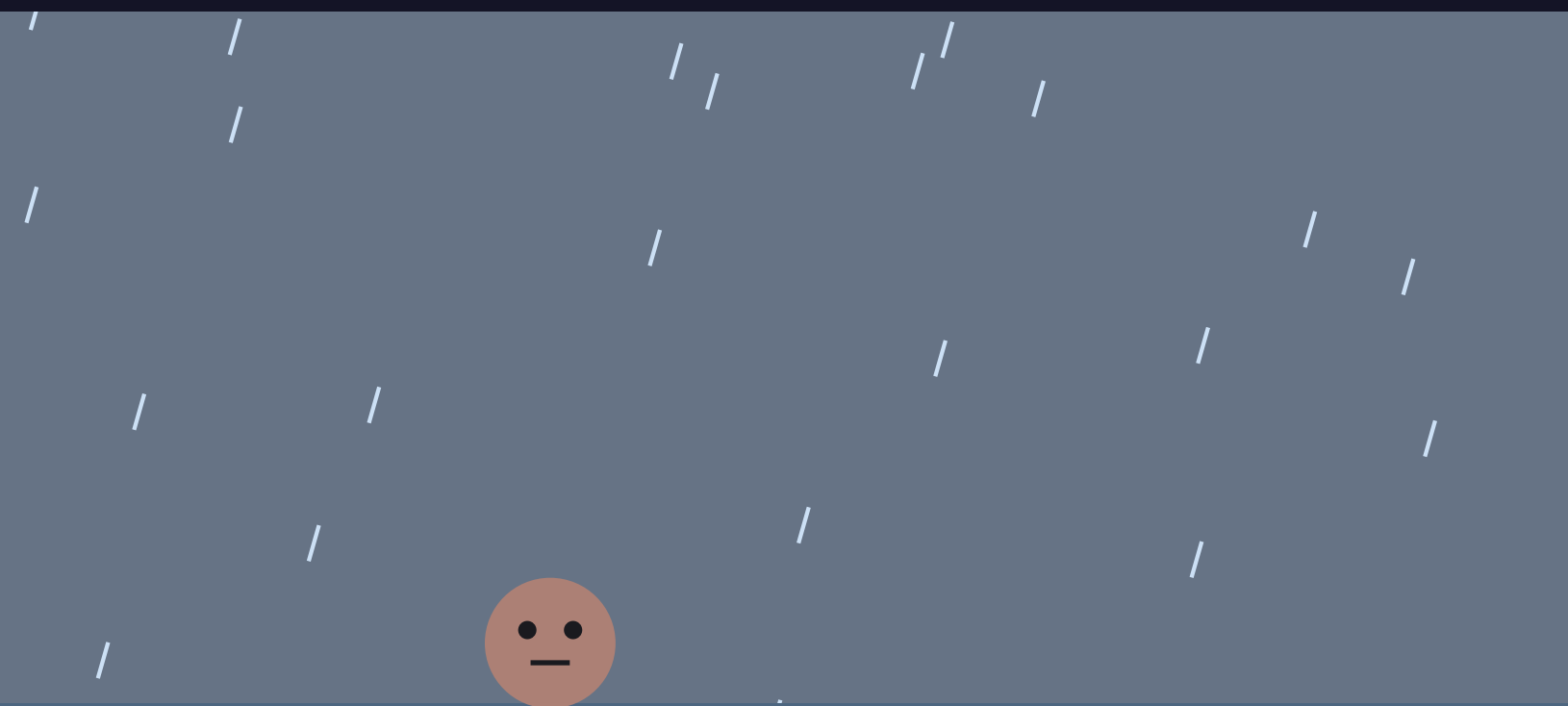


**Far away in a moonlit lake, where few
looked closely, lived a small cloud.**





The small cloud was very small, and the wide a moonlit lake felt so very big.





**Every day the small cloud looked around
and wondered if it could ever matter.**





**Then one morning, something went wrong in
a moonlit lake.**



A dark blue night sky with a large, bright yellow crescent moon in the upper right. Numerous small, white stars of varying sizes are scattered across the sky. The bottom of the image features a dark blue gradient background with two large, dark blue curved shapes at the bottom, resembling hills or a horizon.

**The light went out, and everyone was
afraid.**





**"I am too small," the small cloud
thought. "But I will try anyway."**



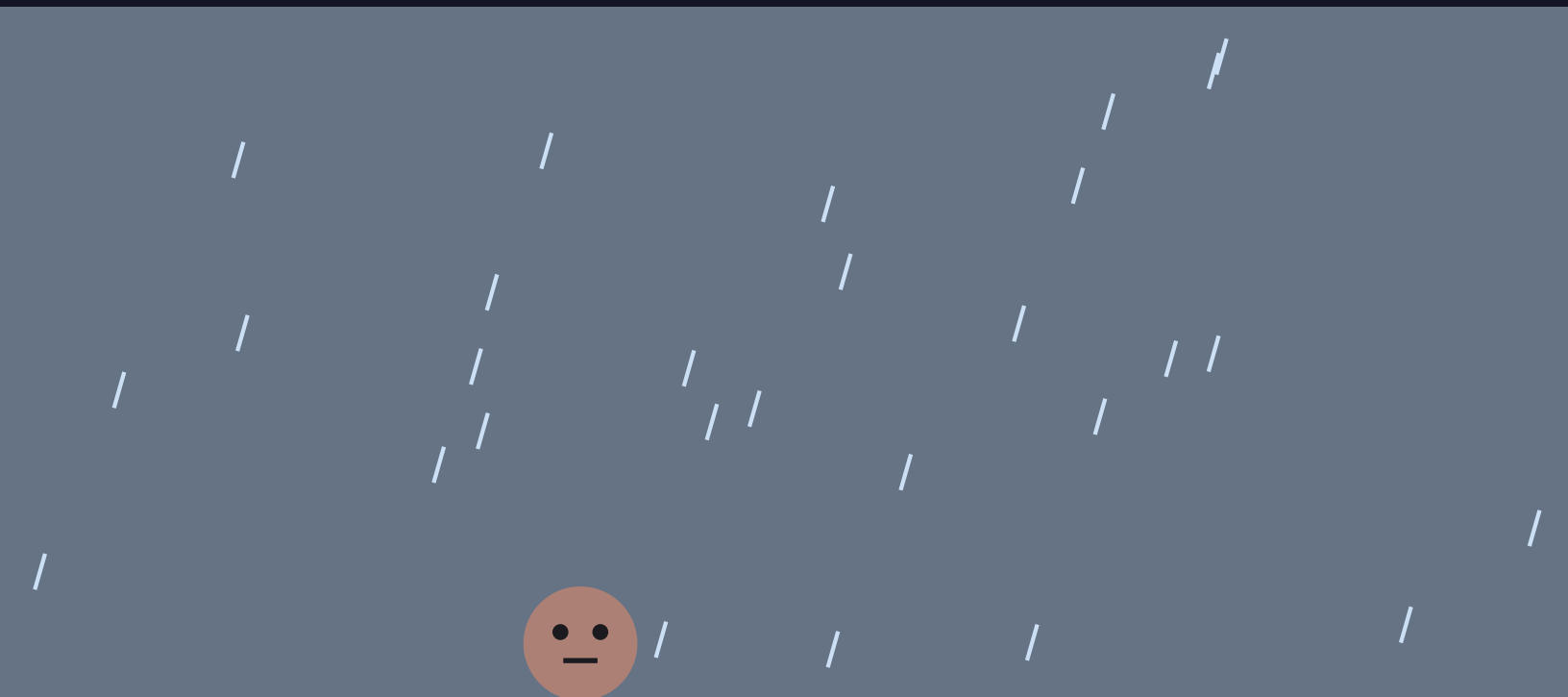


The small cloud took a deep breath and tried with all its heart.





The small cloud sat down and felt very small indeed.





The first try did not work. It only made things wobble.



A dark blue night sky with a yellow crescent moon in the upper right and several small white stars scattered across the upper half.

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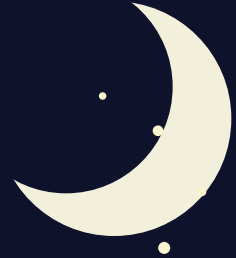
The small cloud sat down and felt very small indeed.



A dark blue night sky with a yellow crescent moon in the upper right and several small yellow stars scattered across the upper half.

But it remembered the faces that needed help, and it stood up again.





**The second try was better. The third was
braver.**





Little by little, the small cloud kept going, and the others began to help too.



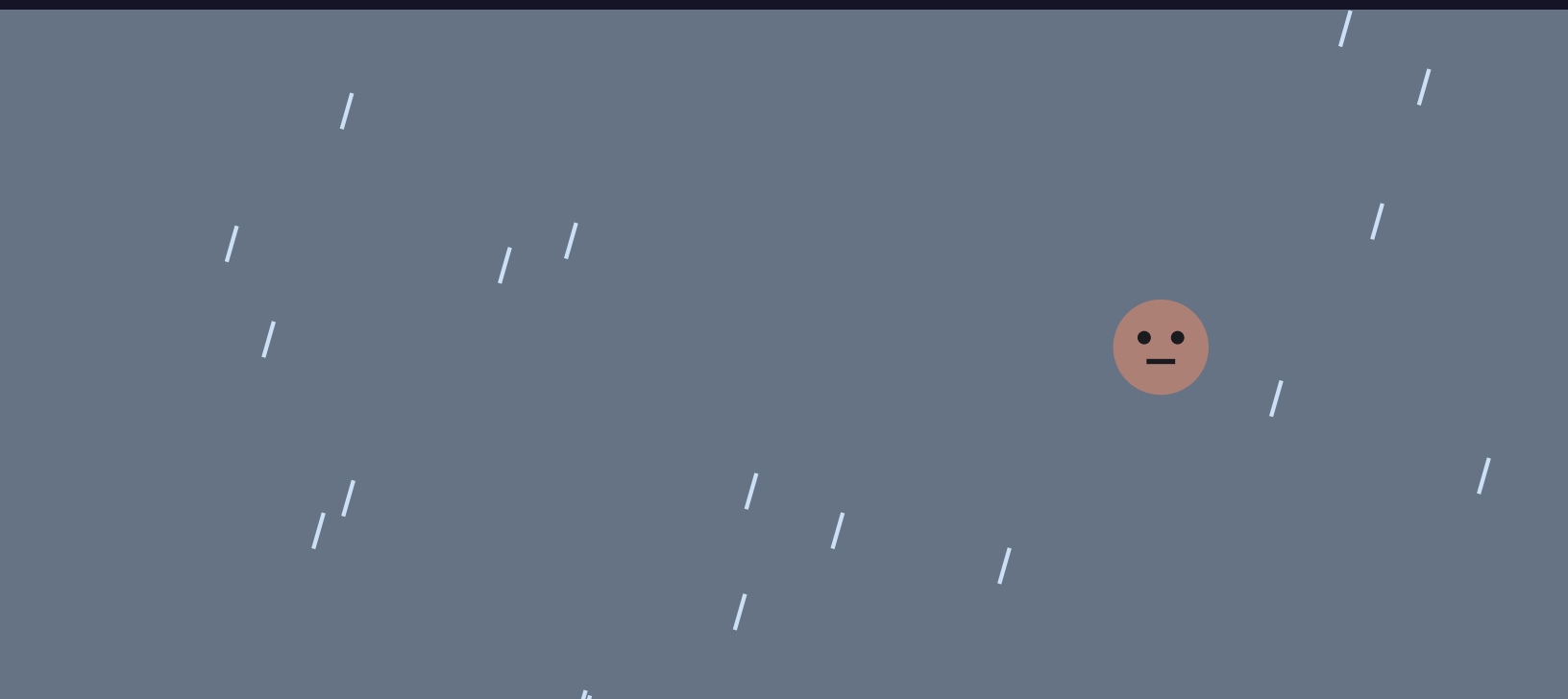


**It was not magic. It was trying, again
and again, until it worked.**





The wind picked up, but the small cloud held on.





**A friend called out, and the small cloud
felt less alone.**





Every time it fell, it learned one new thing.



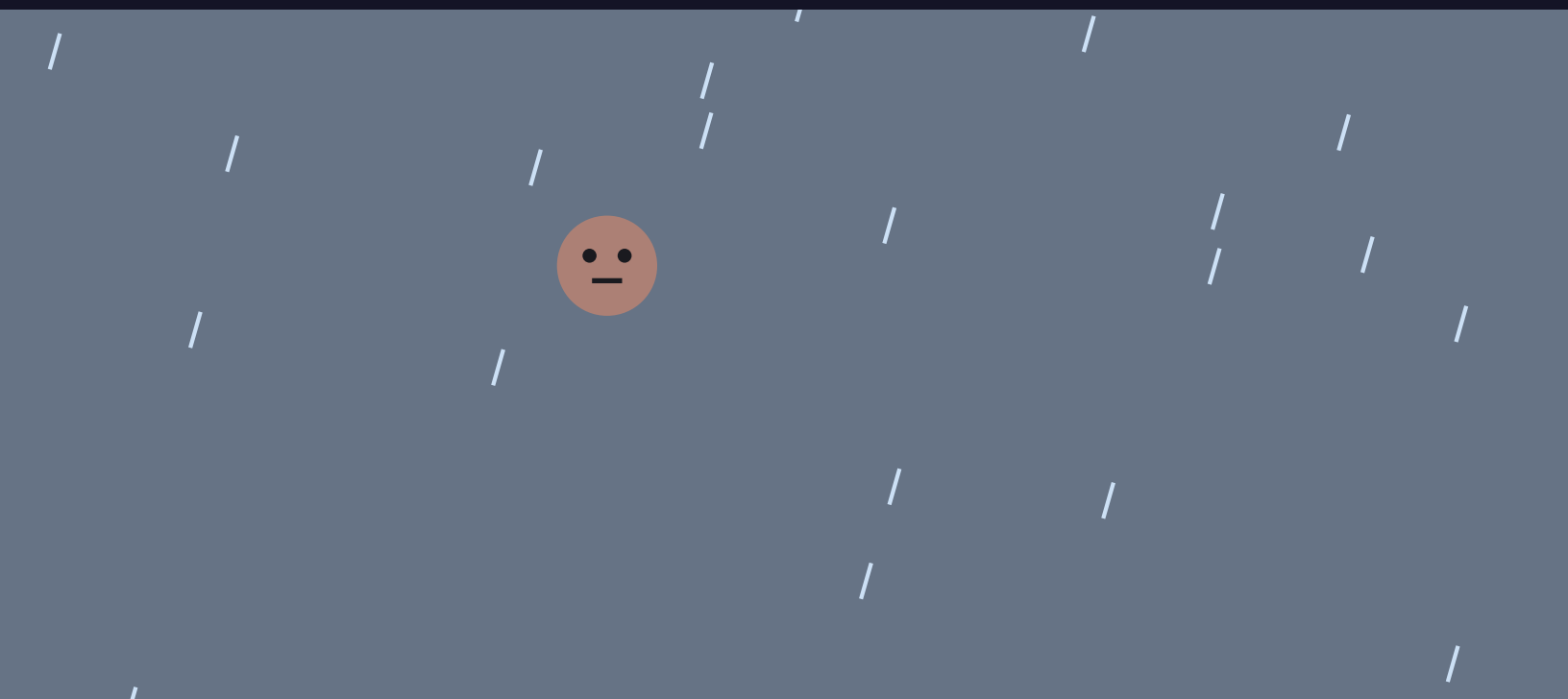


"You can do it," someone whispered. And the small cloud believed it.





Step by step, the small cloud found a new way no one had seen before.





It tried again, and this time, it worked.



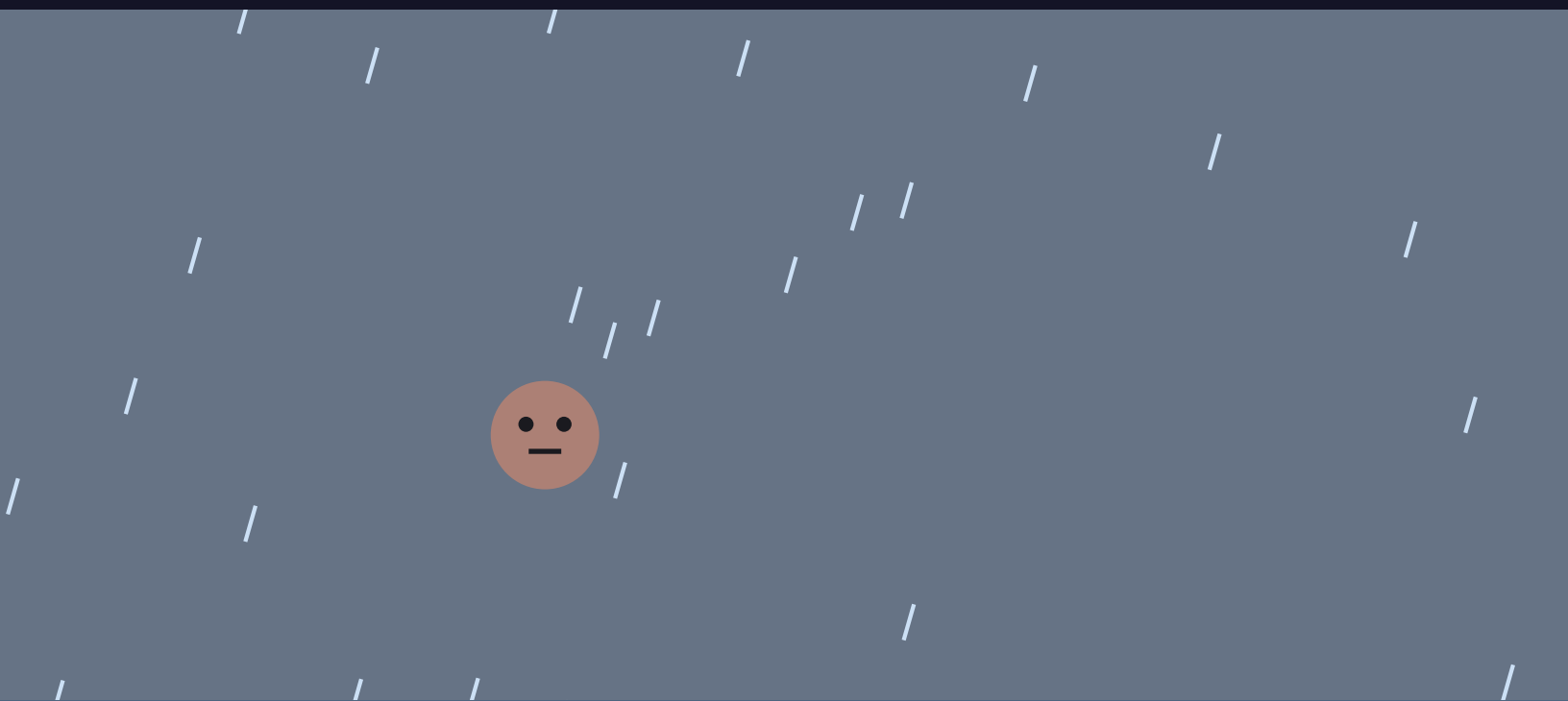


**Everyone in a moonlit lake gathered
around, amazed.**





**The small cloud learned: patience grows
the best things.**





The End

patience grows the best things

